6. Operating profit

The Group has identified a number of items which are material due to the significance of their nature and/or amount. These are listed separately here to provide a better understanding of the financial performance of the Group:

	Note	2019 £m	(Restated) 2018 £m
Staff costs	7	**(56.0)**	(54.5)
Contractor costs		**(0.4)**	(0.4)
Depreciation of property, plant and equipment	14	**(4.9)**	(4.9)
Amortisation of intangible assets	13	**(4.0)**	(4.1)
Profit on sale of property, plant and equipment		**0.1**	–

Following the application of IFRS 16, depreciation of property, plant and equipment has been restated for the year ended 31 March 2018 (note 2).

Services provided by the Company's auditors

During the year, the Group (including overseas subsidiaries) obtained the following services from the operating company's auditors:

	2019 £m	2018 £m
Fees payable for the audit of the Company and consolidated financial statements	**0.1**	0.1
Fees payable for other services:		
– the audit of the subsidiary undertakings pursuant to legislation	**0.2**	0.1
Total	**0.3**	0.2

7. Employee numbers and costs

The average monthly number of employees (including Executive Directors but excluding third-party contractors) employed by the Group was as follows:

	2019 Number	2018 Number
Customer operations	**370**	380
Product and technology	**317**	312
Corporate	**115**	130
Total	**802**	822

The aggregate payroll costs of these persons were as follows:

	2019 £m	2018 £m
Wages and salaries	**43.2**	44.1
Social security costs	**4.7**	4.8
Defined contribution pension costs (note 24)	**2.2**	1.9
	50.1	50.8
Share-based payments and associated NI (note 29)	**5.9**	3.7
Total	**56.0**	54.5

Wages and salaries include £17.3m (2018: £18.1m) relating to the product and technology teams; these teams spend a significant proportion of their time on research and development activities, including innovation of our product proposition and enhancements to the Group's platforms.